of the executive functions that it performs. It started with the point-4 programme and turned into the Expanded Technical Assistance Programme.

The *fourth function* entails partly the security and partly the administrative function related to transport, maintenance and communication and overall security of the UN Commissions in the field.

The *fifth function*, which involves the overall supervision of the international bureaucracy, is performed by the Secretariat and ranges from recruitment, allocation of functions, to performance assessment of its staff.

Finally the Secretariat performs certain diplomatic and political functions. The UN officials sometimes have to think of alternative courses of action by considering the world public opinion and also pressures of national sentiments and national forces when they persuade and negotiate in crisis situations.[14]

Evaluation

The office of the Secretary-General is quite an important one. The role of the Secretary-General is vital to the functioning of the United Nations system. An analysis of the role played by the different Secretaries-General would reveal that there has sometimes been an increase in prestige of the office while sometimes the office has been sidetracked by major powers.

Trygve Lie (Norway), the first Secretary-General of the United Nations, was a dynamic and energetic person and wanted to ensure a more active role of the Unied Nations in the maintenance of international peace and security. He acted by using his rights under Article 99 on the Spanish and Iranian questions at a time when the big powers were at loggerheads.[15] However, given his background as a former politician, he nurtured strong views on many subjects and made no attempt to conceal them. Therefore, his actions in the case of the Korean War won him both acclaim from some quarters and wrath from the Soviet Union. His support for the decision of the Security Council to defend South Korea in the wake of an attack by North Korea in June 1950, led to the accusations by the Soviet